



Sugar A Platform on which Kids Enjoy Learning

Sugar is an award winning learning platform for children, which promotes collaborative learning through activities that are conducive to fostering critical thinking. A consequence of the OLPC project, Sugar has been built from the basics with children in mind and it offers an environment that is different from what's available on typical PCs. This article should be of great interest to educators.

Sugar is an interactive and easy to learn platform for kids. It is a free and open source desktop environment designed for interactive learning for children. It started as a part of the One Laptop Per Child (OLPC) project as its default desktop environment. The mission of OLPC is to develop low cost laptops and provide children around the world with new opportunities. Sugar is free software developed under Sugar Labs, which is a non-profit organisation where developers and educationists work together for the development of the software. Sugar Labs is a community that supports and promotes the Sugar learning platform.

Sugar is an attractive and colourful desktop environment created with the aim of quality education for children. Sugar does not use a desktop, folder or window as its user interface. Instead, it uses a full screen view that helps children to concentrate on one job at a time. It is developed in Python and runs on GNU/Linux. It is released under the GNU General Public License and is available in 25 languages. Most applications in Sugar are the forks of existing applications in GNOME. It is available as a USB-bootable Linux distribution and on live CDs.

Building a Sugar desktop environment

Clone the Sugar build repository from Git:

```
git clone git://github.com/sugarlabs/sugar-build.git
```

Enter the directory and pull the latest source code:

```
cd sugar-build
./osbuild pull
```

Build the source code:

```
./osbuild shell
build
```

Finally, run the Sugar environment:

```
run
```

You will find your Sugar environment open if there is no error. Type Shift-Alt-Q inside Sugar to exit.

To be continue on page... 97